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Academic Position

- 2024–Present **Hanyang University**
Assistant Professor, Department of Sociology
- 2023–2024 **Hong Kong Baptist University**
Assistant Professor, Department of Sociology
- 2020–2023 **Duke-NUS Medical School**
Research Fellow, Centre for Ageing Research and Education (CARE)

Education

- 2020 **National University of Singapore**
Ph.D., Sociology
- 2014 **Korea University**
M.A., Sociology
- 2009 **Korea University**
B.A., Sociology

Research Interests

Social Capital • Social Participation • Social Isolation • Loneliness • Social Gerontology • Caregiving • Longitudinal Analysis

Publications

Peer-Reviewed

- 2026 **Exploring Loneliness in Family Caregiver-Care Recipient Dyads: Implications for Caregiver Burden**
Sung, P., & Chan, A.
Geriatrics & Gerontology International, Accepted.
- 2026 **Oral Health-Related Quality of Life and Social Engagement: Gender Differences**
Sung, P., Zhang, Y., Kang, M., & Kang, S.
Journal of Dental Research, Accepted.
- 2026 **Who Keeps on Learning? Understanding Heterogeneity in Resource Profiles of Older Learners to Promote Recurrent Engagement in Learning**
Sung, P., Maulod, A., Chan, A., & Malhotra, R.
Journal of Aging & Social Policy, Accepted.
- 2026 **Stability and Change in Social Network Profiles after Widowhood and Their Impact on Mental Health among Older Adults**
Sung, P., & Lim-Soh, J.
Population, Space and Place, Accepted.
doi: 10.1002/psp.70231

- 2026 **Getting Lonely and Isolated? Transitions in Social Isolation Profiles Over Time and Factors Associated with Them Among Older Adults**
Sung, P., Lee, J. M.-L., Chan, A., & Visaria, A.
Social Networks, 85: 98–107.
doi: [10.1016/j.socnet.2025.12.005](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socnet.2025.12.005)
- 2025 **Stress, Social Isolation Profiles, and Depressive Symptoms Among Older Adults in a Low-Income Community in Singapore**
Sung, P., Koh, V. J. W., & Chan, A.
International Journal of Geriatric Psychiatry, 40(12): e70183.
doi: [10.1002/gps.70183](https://doi.org/10.1002/gps.70183)
- 2025 **The Mediating Role of Formal Social Engagement in the Relationship Between Oral Health and Depressive Symptoms Among Older Adults in South Korea**
Sung, P., Choi, J., & Zhang, Y.
International Journal of Geriatric Psychiatry, 40(5): e70085.
doi: [10.1002/gps.70085](https://doi.org/10.1002/gps.70085)
- 2025 **Sharing in Caring: Family Caregiving Task Sharing Patterns for Older Adults in Singapore**
Lim-Soh, J., Sung, P., Quach, H.-L., & Malhotra, R.
The Journals of Gerontology: Series B, 80(1): gbae186.
doi: [10.1093/geronb/gbae186](https://doi.org/10.1093/geronb/gbae186)
- 2024 **Functional Limitations and Depressive Symptoms among Older Adults in Korea: Gender Differences in the Moderating Roles of Relationship Satisfaction with Family, Friends, and Neighbors**
Choi, J., & Sung, P.
Journal of Aging and Health, 38(1-2): 31–41.
doi: [10.1177/08982643241304884](https://doi.org/10.1177/08982643241304884)
- 2024 **Stress and Loneliness among Family Caregivers of Older Persons with Cognitive Impairment: The Mediating Role of Social Isolation and the Moderating Role of Personal Mastery**
Sung, P., Lim-Soh, J., Lee, J. M.-L., & Chan, A.
Journal of Aging and Health, Advance online publication.
doi: [10.1177/08982643241262374](https://doi.org/10.1177/08982643241262374)
- 2024 **A Reciprocal Relationship between Formal and Informal Social Engagement and Handgrip Strength of Older Adults in South Korea**
Son, J., & Sung, P.
Gerontology, 70(10): 1088–1102.
doi: [10.1159/000540344](https://doi.org/10.1159/000540344)
- 2024 **The Relationship among Generalized Trust, Social Networks, and Social Resources across Thirty Countries**
Son, J., & Sung, P.
International Sociology, 39(4): 375–398.
doi: [10.1177/02685809241251770](https://doi.org/10.1177/02685809241251770)
- 2024 **Informal Caregiver Social Network Types and Mental Health: The Mediating Role of Psychological Resilience**
Sung, P., Lim-Soh, J., & Malhotra, R.
Journal of Aging & Social Policy, 36(4): 693–708.
doi: [10.1080/08959420.2024.2319535](https://doi.org/10.1080/08959420.2024.2319535)
- 2024 **Trajectories of Adherence to a Falls Prevention Exercise Intervention in Singapore: A Mixed Methods Study**
Lee, J. M.-L., Sung, P., Tan, K. Y., Duncan, P., Sim, R., Koh, K., & Chan, A.
Aging and Health Research, 4(1): 100181.
doi: [10.1016/j.ahr.2024.100181](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ahr.2024.100181)

- 2024 **Feeling Alone Together: Loneliness in Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment and Their Family Caregivers with Low Mastery**
Sung, P., Lim-Soh, J., & Chan, A.
Dementia and Geriatric Cognitive Disorders, 53(2): 66–73.
doi: [10.1159/000536644](https://doi.org/10.1159/000536644)
- 2024 **Engagement in Physical Activity and Quality of Life Among Informal Caregivers of Older Adults**
A'Azman, S., Sung, P., & Malhotra, R.
Journal of Aging and Health, 36(10): 667–677.
doi: [10.1177/08982643231209086](https://doi.org/10.1177/08982643231209086)
- 2023 **Older Adult Patient Preferences for the Content and Format of Prescription Medication Labels – A Best-worst Scaling and Discrete Choice Experiment Study**
Malhotra, R., Suppiah, S. D., Tan, Y. W., Sung, P., Tay, S. S. C., Tan, N. C., Koh, G. C.-H., Chan, A., Chew, L. S. T., & Ozdemir, S.
Research in Social and Administrative Pharmacy, 19(11): 1455–1464.
doi: [10.1016/j.sapharm.2023.07.009](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.sapharm.2023.07.009)
- 2023 **Health Profiles among Community Dwelling Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment and Their Implications for Caregiving Experience**
Sung, P., Lim-Soh, J., & Chan, A.
Dementia and Geriatric Cognitive Disorders, 52(3): 169–176.
doi: [10.1159/000530606](https://doi.org/10.1159/000530606)
- 2023 **Reciprocal Relationship Between Lifelong Learning and Volunteering**
Sung, P., Chia, A., Chan, A., & Malhotra, R.
The Journals of Gerontology: Series B, 78(5): 902–912.
doi: [10.1093/geronb/gbad003](https://doi.org/10.1093/geronb/gbad003)
- 2023 **Lonely in a Crowd: Social Isolation Profiles and Caregiver Burden Among Family Caregivers of Community-dwelling Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment**
Sung, P., Lee, J. M.-L., & Chan, A.
Journal of Aging and Health, 35(5-6): 419–429.
doi: [10.1177/08982643221137939](https://doi.org/10.1177/08982643221137939)
- 2023 **Relationship Between Social Engagement and Cognitive Function Among Older Adults in South Korea**
Son, J., & Sung, P.
Journal of Applied Gerontology, 42(5): 928–941.
doi: [10.1177/07334648221148953](https://doi.org/10.1177/07334648221148953)
- 2023 **Does a Reciprocal Relationship Exist between Social Engagement and Depression in Later Life?**
Son, J., & Sung, P.
Aging & Mental Health, 27(1): 70–80.
doi: [10.1080/13607863.2021.2024794](https://doi.org/10.1080/13607863.2021.2024794)
- 2022 **Met and Unmet Needs of Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment, and Burden and Benefits of Their Family Caregivers**
Sung, P., Hashim, N., Malhotra, R., & Chan, A.
Alzheimer Disease & Associated Disorders, 36(4): 300–306.
doi: [10.1097/WAD.0000000000000529](https://doi.org/10.1097/WAD.0000000000000529)
- 2022 **Care Needs Profiles and Their Association with Caregiver Strain among Community-Dwelling Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment**
Sung, P., & Chan, A.
Dementia and Geriatric Cognitive Disorders, 51(4): 340–347.
doi: [10.1159/000525999](https://doi.org/10.1159/000525999)

- 2022 **The Negative Impact of Adult Children's Marital Dissolution on Older Parents' Mental Health in South Korea**
Ko, P.-C., & Sung, P.
The Journals of Gerontology: Series B, 77(9): 1721–1731.
doi: [10.1093/geronb/gbac056](https://doi.org/10.1093/geronb/gbac056)
- 2022 **Transitions Between Social Network Profiles and Their Relation with All-cause Mortality among Older Adults**
Cheng, G. H.-L., Sung, P., Chan, A., Ma, S., & Malhotra, R.
Social Science & Medicine, 292: 114617.
doi: [10.1016/j.socscimed.2021.114617](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socscimed.2021.114617)
- 2022 **Transition in Social Network Types over Time among Older Adults**
Sung, P., Malhotra, R., Cheng, G. H.-L., & Chan, A.
Gerontology, 68(7): 817–828.
doi: [10.1159/000521213](https://doi.org/10.1159/000521213)
- 2022 **Types of Caregiving Experience and Their Association with Caregiver Depressive Symptoms and Quality of Life**
Sung, P., Goh, V. S., Azman, N. D., Visaria, A., & Malhotra, R.
Journal of Aging and Health, 34(4-5): 591–601.
doi: [10.1177/08982643211051568](https://doi.org/10.1177/08982643211051568)
- 2020 **In-Group Trust and Self-Rated Health in East Asia Using Quadri-National Survey Data**
Sung, P., & Son, J.
International Journal of Comparative Sociology, 61(1): 27–58.
doi: [10.1177/0020715220937752](https://doi.org/10.1177/0020715220937752)
- Book Chapter & Encyclopedia Entry*
- 2025 **Urban-rural Disparities in Social Network Profiles among Older Koreans at the Early Stage of the Pandemic**
Sung, P.
Social Connection in Everyday Spaces. Bristol University Press.
doi: [10.51952/9781529246735.ch007](https://doi.org/10.51952/9781529246735.ch007)
- 2024 **The Latent Classes of the Volunteer Satisfaction Index and Donation during the Pandemic in Singapore**
Son, J., Sung, P., & Tay, B.
Well-being During the Pandemic: Comparative Perspectives from the Global North and the Global South. Springer International.
doi: [10.1007/978-3-031-63440-6_9](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-63440-6_9)
- 2021 **Buffering Function**
Sung, P.
Encyclopedia of Gerontology and Population Aging. Springer International.
doi: [10.1007/978-3-030-22009-9_506](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-22009-9_506)
- Research Report*
- 2022 **Met and Unmet Needs of Community-dwelling Older Singaporeans with Cognitive Impairment**
Sung, P., Hashim, N., & Chan, A.
Centre for Ageing Research and Education, Research Brief Series 13
doi: [10.25722/y68m-tn8x](https://doi.org/10.25722/y68m-tn8x)
- 2020 **Transitions in Health, Employment, Social Engagement and Intergenerational Transfers in Singapore Study (THE SIGNS Study) – II: Cross-Sectional and Longitudinal Analyses of Key Aspects of Successful Ageing**
Chan, A., Malhotra, R., Visaria, A., Sung, P., Ching, B. J. S. S., & Wen, T. Y.

Work in Progress

☒ under review ☐ draft available

- ☒ **Associating Multimorbidity Patterns with Healthcare Utilization and Unmet Healthcare Needs among Older Koreans Living Alone**
Yun, H., Son, B., & Sung, P.
- ☒ **Lonely by Comparison: Understanding Loneliness Through Network Alter Status, Ego status, and Regional Status**
Sung, P., Sung, W., & Kim, H.
- ☒ **Stability and Transitions in Social Network Types in the Pandemic Outbreak and Their Association with Mid-pandemic Depression among Older Koreans**
Sung, P., & Son, J.
- ☐ **The Strength of Strong Ties: Resources in Close Relationships and Life Satisfaction Across 30 Countries**
Sung, P., & Son, J.
- ☐ **Drifting into Isolation or Growing into the Core? Joint Trajectories of In-Degree and Out-Degree Centrality and Later-Life Cognitive Function among Older Adults**
Sung, P., & Youm, Y.
- ☐ **Adherence Trajectories and Determinants of Adherence Transition Patterns from Active Intervention to Self-Maintenance Phases of an Exercise-based Falls Prevention Programme**
Koh, V. J. W., Sung, P., Tan, K. Y., Lee, J. M.-L., & Chan, A.
- ☐ **Post-retirement Trajectories of Depressive Symptoms in South Korea: The Positive Role of Returning to Work**
Lim-Soh, J., Xiang, C. H., Ang, S., Sung, P., & Malhotra, R.
- ☐ **The Strength of Strong Ties: Resources in Close Relationships and Life Satisfaction Across 30 Countries**
Sung, P., & Son, J.

Presentations

 scheduled

Conference Presentations

- 2025–2026 **Oral Health-Related Quality of Life and Formal Social Engagement Among Older Adults: How Does Gender Matter?**
 - '26 Singapore Conference on Ageing and Health 2026 @ Singapore
 - '25 Hong Kong Sociological Association 26th Annual Conference @ Hong Kong
- 2025 **Who Keeps on Learning? Understanding Heterogeneity in Resource Profiles of Older Learners to Promote Recurrent Engagement in Learning**
 - Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting @ Seoul, Korea
- 2025 **Lonely by Comparison: Individual, Network, and Regional Occupational Status and Loneliness across 30 Countries**
 - 5th ISA Forum of Sociology @ Rabat, Morocco
- 2025 **Reciprocal Relationship Between Oral Health and Social Engagement Among Older Adults: A Gendered Story**
 - 5th ISA Forum of Sociology @ Rabat, Morocco

- 2024–2025 **Exploring Loneliness in Family Caregiver-Care Recipient Dyads: Implications for Caregiver Burden**
 – '25 *Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting @ Singapore*
 – '24 *Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting @ Seoul, Korea*
- 2024–2025 **Connected, yet Vulnerable: Stress, Social Isolation, and Mental Health among Older Adults**
 – '25 *Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting @ Singapore*
 – '24 *Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting @ Seoul, Korea*
- 2024 **Mechanisms Linking Oral Health and Mental Health in Later Life: The Mediating Role of Social Engagement and Life Satisfaction**
 – *International Alliance of Research Universities ALH Scientific Conference @ Oxford, UK*
 – *Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting @ Singapore*
- 2023 **Stability and Change in Social Network Profiles after Widowhood and Their Impact on Mental Health among Older Adults**
 – *Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting @ Seoul, Korea*
- 2023 **Oral Health, Social Engagement, and Depressive Symptoms among Older Adults**
 – *Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting @ Seoul, Korea*
- 2023 **Understanding Resource Profiles of Older Learners to Promote Recurring Engagement in Learning**
 – *Hong Kong Sociological Association 24th Annual Conference @ Hong Kong*
 – *Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting @ Tampa, Florida*
- 2023 **Feeling Alone Together: Loneliness among Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment and their Family Caregivers with Low Mastery**
 – *Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting @ Tampa, Florida*
 – *Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting @ Jeonju, Korea*
- 2023 **Profiles of Volunteer Motivations During the COVID-19 Pandemic and Their Implications for Volunteer Activities**
 – *XX ISA World Congress of Sociology @ Melbourne, Australia*
- 2023 **Social Capital and Life Satisfaction: A Cross-national Comparison.**
 – *Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting @ Jeonju, Korea*
- 2022–2023 **Stability and Change in Social Isolation Profiles over Time Among Older Adults**
 – '23 *Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting @ Tampa, Florida*
 – '22 *International Alliance of Research Universities ALH Scientific Conference @ Copenhagen, Denmark*
- 2022–2023 **Change in Social Network Types among Older Koreans before and during the COVID-19 Pandemic**
 – '23 *XX ISA World Congress of Sociology @ Melbourne, Australia*
 – '23 *Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting @ Singapore*
 – '22 *Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting @ Seoul, Korea*
 – '22 *Japan Sociological Society Annual Meeting @ Osaka, Japan*
- 2022–2023 **Caregiver Social Network Types and Depressive Symptoms: The Mediating Role of Psychological Resilience**
 – '23 *Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting @ Singapore*
 – '22 *Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting @ Seoul, Korea*
- 2022 **Transitions in Social Network Types among Older Singaporeans**
 – *International Alliance of Research Universities ALH Scientific Conference @ Copenhagen, Denmark*
- 2022 **Transitions in Social Support Exchange Profiles over Time among Older Adults**
 – *Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting @ Indianapolis, Indiana*
- 2021 **Profiles of Met and Unmet Needs of Cognitively Impaired Older Singaporeans and Their Association with Caregiver Well-being**
 – *Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting @ Virtual*

- 2021 **Met and Unmet Needs of Cognitively Impaired Older Adults and Burden and Benefits of Their Caregivers**
– *Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting @ Virtual*
- 2021 **Transitions in Adherence Trajectories from Intervention to Maintenance of a Falls Prevention Exercise Program**
– *Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting @ Virtual*
- 2020 **Caregiving Experience Types and Caregiver Quality of Life**
– *Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting @ Virtual*
- 2018 **Trust, Social Participation, and Depression among Older Adults in Low- and Middle-Income Countries**
– *International Alliance of Research Universities ALH Scientific Conference @ Singapore*
- 2018 **Trust and Well-being: A Multi-country Analysis**
– *XIX International Sociological Association World Congress of Sociology @ Toronto, Canada*
- 2018 **Trust and Self-rated health in East Asia**
– *International Sociological Association RC 28 Spring Meeting @ Seoul, Korea*
- 2018 **Parental Volunteering, Church Attendance, and Young Adults' Volunteering**
– *International Sociological Association joint conference for RCo6 & RC41 @ Singapore*
- 2015 **Global Pioneer Seeks for Globality: Institutionalization, Crisis, and Restructuring of E-Sports in Korea**
– *East Asian Conference for Young Sociologists @ Seoul, Korea*
- 2014 **Structural change in the Oil industry in Korea**
– *Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting @ Seoul, Korea*
- Invited Talks*
- 2025 **Lonely by Comparison: Individual, Network, and Regional Occupational Status and Loneliness across 30 Countries**
– *Medical sociology colloquium, Korea University*
- 2025 **Social Determinants of Mental Health Among Older Adults in Korea**
– *Korea University Institute of Aging*
– *Korea Inequality Research Network*
- 2024 **Trust and Social Capital**
– *Global Multicultural Education Center, Sun Moon University*
- 2024 **Reciprocal Relationship Between Oral Health and Social Engagement among Older Adults: A Gendered Story**
– *Medical sociology colloquium, Ewha Womans University*
- 2024 **Stability and Change in Social Network Profiles after Widowhood and Their Impact on Mental Health among Older Koreans**
– *Department of Geography, National University of Singapore*
- 2023 **Multi-wave Panel Data Analysis**
– *Department of Internal Medicine, The Catholic University of Korea*
- 2023 **Composition and Dynamics of Social Networks among Older Singaporeans**
– *Centre for Ageing Research and Education, Duke-NUS Medical School*
- 2022 **Health Profiles among Community Dwelling Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment and Their Implications for Caregiving Experience**
– *Singapore General Hospital 24th Annual Scientific Meeting*

- 2022 **Transition in Social Network Types among Older Singaporeans and Implications to Life-space Studies**
– *Singapore Population Health Symposium*
- 2021 **The Reciprocal Relationship Between Volunteering and Lifelong Learning**
– *Centre for Ageing Research and Education, Duke-NUS Medical School*
- 2021 **Profiles of Caregiving Experience Types Based on the Benefits and Burden of Caregiving, and Their Association with Caregiver Mental Health and Quality of Life**
– *Centre for Ageing Research and Education, Duke-NUS Medical School*
- 2020 **Social Networks and Health among Older Adults**
– *Department of Sociology, Korea University*
- 2019 **Social Capital and Life Satisfaction**
– *Department of Sociology, National University of Singapore*
- 2019 **Online Interaction and Out-group Trust**
– *Centre for Family and Population Research, National University of Singapore*
- 2019 **Trust and Happiness among Older Adults in Low- and Middle-income Countries**
– *Faculty of Arts & Social Science Research Division Health Cluster, National University of Singapore*
- 2018 **Social Capital and Trust**
– *Department of Sociology, National University of Singapore*

Honors, Grants & Awards

- 2025–2026 HYU International collaboration Grant (PI), Hanyang University
- 2024 Start-up Grant, Hanyang University
- 2024 Travel Award, Department of Geography, National University of Singapore
- 2023 Start-up Grant, Hong Kong Baptist University
- 2022 Travel Award, Japanese Sociological Society
- 2015–2019 Research Scholarship, Department of Sociology, National University of Singapore
- 2015 The Best Article Award, Korea University Graduate Studies
- 2012–2014 Research Scholarship, Korea University

Teaching Experience

Hanyang University

- 2025–2026 Health and Social Behavior [SOC4046]
Social Problems [SOC3032]
Medical Sociology Seminar (Graduate) [SOC9116]
Social Networks and Social Capital (Graduate) [SOC9115]
- 2024 Sociology and the New Industrial Revolution [SOC1055]
Intermediate Social Statistics (Graduate) [SOC9109]

Hong Kong Baptist University

- 2023–2024 Careers and Life Courses [SOCI3027]
Globalization [SOCI4016]

Duke-NUS Medical School

- 2021–2023 Methods Workshop: Latent Class/Transition Analysis
- '23 '22 '21 Centre for Ageing Research and Education, Duke-NUS Medical School
 - '22 Association of Pacific Rim Universities Population Aging Program
 - '22 Department of Sociology, Korea University

National University of Singapore

- 2015–2018 Teaching Assistant
- '18 Data Analysis in Social Research [SC3209]
 - '17 Sociology of Life Course and Ageing [SC3214]
 - '16 Understanding Globalization [GEK1041]
 - '15 Making Sense of Society [SC1101]

Professional Service

Editorial Board Member

- 2024–Present BMC Geriatrics
- 2024–Present Korean Journal of Sociology [in Korean]
- 2023–2024 Journal of the Korean Gerontological Society [in Korean]
- 2023–2024 Health and Social Science [in Korean]

Journal Reviewer

Aging and Health Research • Australian & New Zealand Journal of Public Health • BMC Geriatrics • BMC Public Health • Dementia and Geriatric Cognitive Disorders • Health & Place • Health Psychology • Health and Social Science • International Journal of Comparative Sociology • Journal of Aging and Health • Journal of Applied Gerontology • Journal of the Korean Gerontological Society • Korea Journal of Population Studies • Korean Journal of Sociology • Scientific Reports • Social Science Research • Sociology of Health & Illness • The Gerontologist • The Journals of Gerontology, Series B

Grant Reviewer

- 2023 Seed Grant Funding Scheme, Hong Kong Baptist University

Conference

- 2022–2025 Organizing Committee Member
- '25 19th Seoul International Symposium on Gerontology
 - '23 Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting
 - '22 The 12th Association of Pacific Rim University Population Ageing Conference

Professional Organization Membership

Gerontological Society of America
Hong Kong Sociological Association
International Alliance of Research Universities Aging, Longevity and Health Early Career Researcher Networks
International Sociological Association
– Research Committee Membership: RC55 Social Indicators
Korean Gerontological Association
Korean Sociological Association
Population Association of Singapore